

Interview Thesis Brief

PMI · Senior Manager, Business Process Excellence

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MANDATE HYPOTHESIS

Build an enterprise mechanism that turns cross-functional process friction into a governed portfolio of redesign interventions, separates necessary local variation from process debt, clarifies end-to-end ownership and decision rights, and proves whether redesigned work creates sustained business value.

COMPANY MOMENT

Portfolio transformation PMI reports that its smoke-free business generated 43% of total global net revenues in Q1 2026, with more than 43 million estimated legal-age consumers across 108 markets.	Transformation system PMI describes transformation as powered by science, data, digital innovation, human judgment, and responsible decision-making.
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OPERATING TENSIONS

Global vs local Standardize enough to scale without flattening regulatory and market reality.	Speed vs traceability Transform quickly while preserving control logic and evidence.
Ambition vs capacity Prioritize against finite organizational change bandwidth.	Visibility vs adoption Data exposes friction; routines determine behavior.
End-to-end vs function Own outcomes without creating parallel bureaucracy.	

WHITE-SPACE THESIS

Business Process Excellence should behave like a Process Genome: define the stable core, make legitimate variants explicit, detect harmful mutations, and evolve standards from evidence.

STRONGEST OBJECTION

Concern: Russell has no direct tobacco/nicotine background. **Response:** acknowledge the gap, then make the adjacent-evidence argument across transformation, manufacturing and quality systems, high-reliability operations, regulated aviation, 24/7 logistics, and AI-enabled workflow design.

Thesis Brief · Proof & Discussion

Process excellence as a living enterprise system

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PROOF MAP

Evidence	Verified fact	Role relevance
Vape-Jet	Current AI-first operating transformation across business functions and systems.	Direct redesign, handoffs, visibility, and adoption.
Amazon	24/7 mechanisms supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.	Scale, cadence, flow, ownership, escalation.
Compunetics	High-reliability engineering, manufacturing, quality systems, controls, and root cause.	Technical/business translation and control discipline.
DudeWorth	AI-readiness and agentic workflow patterns with human judgment and governance rails.	AI tied to work, economics, governance, and adoption.

FIRST 120 DAYS

0–30 · Decode Stakeholder map, taxonomy, two pilots, baseline scorecard, variant and exception inventory.	31–60 · Make variation explicit Process Genome maps, process contracts, decision rights, controls, and system seams.
61–90 · Run targeted trials Hypothesis-led interventions with outcome, flow, risk, economics, and behavior evidence.	91–120 · Institutionalize learning Portfolio governance, owner cadence, benefit validation, and scaling rules.

EXECUTIVE QUESTIONS

- Where does PMI currently feel transformation friction most?
- Which processes have true enterprise owners?
- How does PMI distinguish required variation from process debt?
- How are improvement benefits validated and sustained?
- What decision authority does this role hold directly?
- Where is process excellence experienced as overhead?

RESEARCH BASIS

Official PMI corporate site and Q1 2026 progress indicators; PMI Value Report 2025 hub; PMI Careers overview; PMI 'The human edge in the age of AI.' The original job URL is preserved, but its body remained unavailable; no JD-specific responsibility or qualification was invented.